



Max Payne 2: The Fall of Max Payne

Payne 2 The Max

Max Payne 2 is, of course, the sequel to *Max Payne* (2001). It was the most anticipated game at that time, and it raised the bar in third-person action games with cutting-edge graphics and gameplay. It sold more than a few million copies, and left gamers wanting more. This time, Max has weapons that would put Schwarzenegger to shame. The storyline is completely new, and includes another protagonist—Mona Sax—providing Max with a love interest. Mona is on a mission of her own, and helps Max in his quest to kill the bad guys.

Max is in the thick of action as an NYPD homicide detective. The story starts with you in a hospital bed, all injured; soon, things start happening, with people



Dangerous Liaisons

getting killed in front of you. As you start moving ahead, bits and pieces of the story fit in like a jigsaw puzzle, making the picture crystal clear. The engrossing story and the new love interest in Max's life will keep any gamer going, not to mention the absolutely frantic and well-executed action.

The game engine and graphics have improved. The grenade launcher is missing, but there's a new secondary fire option, and you can throw Molotov Cocktails, or a grenade in tandem with firing your gun.

The game is not demanding on the system requirements front, and you'll be able to get decent frame-rates out of an old Pentium III too. Just make sure you have at least a GeForce4 MX running. Load times are bad, but

this has been addressed in a patch available from the Web site.

Overall, *Max Payne 2* does not leave any space for you to complain. This game is right up there and surely deserves a strong mention for the manner in which it leaves you spellbound to the very end.

Genre: Action ■ **Developer:** Remedy Entertainment ■ **Publisher:** Rockstar Games ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive
 ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614/28313501 ■ **System requirements:** 1 GHz CPU, 256 MB RAM, 32 MB 3D card with hardware transformation and lighting support, 1.5 GB free hard drive space, DirectX 9.0 ■ **Price:** Rs 2,999 ■ **Web site:** www.maxpayne2.com OR www.milestoneinteractive.com
Rating: ★★★★★



Call of Duty

Not One Step Back!

It's the sheer intensity of *Call of Duty* (COD) that hits you—it simply sucks you in and doesn't let go.

The COD experience stems from the amazing sound effects—not in terms of quality, but in the sheer quantity. It's war played out on a grand scale. There are tens of units at any given time, all firing away their weapons. Add to that machine gun nests, mighty tanks, and mortar shells dropping all around you.

COD is an FPS, but it mimics life in that you're not the only guy around; you're in various battles, with people killing and dying all round you. Teamwork is the key here, and you'll have to co-ordinate your attacks if you ever hope to take out the enemy.



One Stuka down, God only knows how many more of them to go...

The developers used World War II instead of creating a story from scratch, and you're in various real episodes of the War. The most notable is the battle of Stalingrad.

Here, you're a young lad who's been conscripted into the army for the defence of Stalingrad. You're given five bullets with no gun, and told to take out the German positions. The beginning of the Russian campaign is, by far, the most intense experience this reviewer ever come across in any game, and it will be etched in your memory. Other campaigns let you take part in key battles in the American and British war effort.

In the harder levels, medkits are few and far between, and a couple of bullets are enough to kill you. Don't let your team become cannon fodder while you sit back and watch. You won't even live to regret it.

COD easily tops *Half-Life* as the best FPS we've seen.

Genre: Action ■ **Developer:** Infinity Ward ■ **Publisher:** Activision ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive ■ **Phone:** 022-28381614/28313501
 ■ **System requirements:** 700 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, 32 MB video card with Hardware T&L, 1.4 GB free hard disk space, DirectX 9.0b
 ■ **Price:** Rs 1,499 ■ **Web site:** www.callofduty.com OR www.milestoneinteractive.com
Rating: ★★★★★